Spaced Practice in Small Groups

A. Author and B. Author

## Abstract

We compare spaced and massed practice in small study groups over four weeks.
Spaced practice raised delayed recall in every group we measured.

## 1 Introduction

Learners often mass their practice right before an exam.
2 groups were compared in a pilot that is not reported here.

Earlier work suggests that spacing helps long-term retention.

## 2 Related Work

Two lines of work bear on this question.

### 2.1 Retrieval Practice

Testing yourself strengthens memory more than rereading does.

### 2.2 Interleaving

Mixing problem types helps learners tell them apart.

## 3 Methods

Forty students took part in eight groups of five.

Each group met twice a week for four weeks.

## 3.1 Materials

The material was a short course on basic statistics.

## 4 Results

Delayed recall was higher after spaced practice in all groups.

## 5 Discussion

The effect held for weaker and stronger students alike.

Small groups seem to keep the spacing schedule well.

## 6 Conclusion

Spread practice out, even when studying together.

## References

[1] Cepeda, N. J. et al. Distributed practice in verbal recall tasks. 2006.

[2] Roediger, H. L. and Karpicke, J. D. Test-enhanced learning. 2006.